The inherited record and the solo contribution

two columns at the Semester-3 boundary; every item is drawn from the repository's own provenance record

Semester 3 — inherited (group project)

Group 6: six students, guides A. R. Paduri and N. Darapaneni; the candidate was a member of that group.

1 Research direction

A multi-framework benchmark: one post-training recipe run across libraries, so that the libraries themselves can be compared.

2 Repository and tooling

The multi-framework repository and its baseline integrations, the shared runtime code, and the Tinker, TRL, veRL and OpenRLHF adapters.

3 Experiments and evidence

The initial Tinker, SkyRL and GRPO experiments, the group literature foundation, and the early benchmark and evaluation scaffolding.

4 Outputs and authorship

The Semester-3 record as the group left it, frozen on 23 April 2026 at the capstone tag.

Semester 4 — the candidate's own work

solo continuation under guide R. P. Guledgudd; the research direction, the experiments and the papers are the candidate's own.

1 Research direction

A new direction of the candidate's own: measure when the group-relative signal vanishes, and establish what a stack-conditioned result must report before it can be attributed.

2 Repository and tooling

Instrumentation and analysis built on that code: new GRPO diagnostics and controllers, the reporting and registry work, and the Berkeley-course-inspired audits and prototypes.

3 Experiments and evidence

The post-capstone experiment and audit expansion: the scaling, ZVF, group-size, length-bias, fraud and statistical analyses, spanning 206 recorded analysis iterations.

4 Outputs and authorship

The eight standalone P1–P8 papers and their current authorship, the NeurIPS workshop variant, and this thesis and its figures.

23 April 2026 · the Semester-3 boundary

Where the boundary is drawn

The boundary and the record

- Semester-3 tag `capstone-final-2026-04-25`; boundary commit `21a99ef7`, dated 23 April 2026.
- The post-capstone span holds 584 commits and 5,050 changed files, and the continuation adds 206 recorded analysis iterations.
- The split is recorded at paper level in commit `282e6b4f`, 7 July 2026.

How to read the two columns

- Left is what the group project produced; right is what the candidate added on top of it in Semester 4.
- The repository's own caveat: *"This distinction is about academic contribution. It does not duplicate or relocate the shared runtime code."*
- The changed-file count measures activity, not academic contribution.